

Swoon — Pre-Alpha MVP Scope (YC Demo Build)

Goal: A working demo of the core loop — two verified-looking users get matched and complete a live 3-minute video date, then mutually match. Target: demo-ready by Sunday.

Guiding rule: If it isn't visible in a 60-second screen recording of the core loop, it doesn't get built yet.

P0 — Must work end to end

1. Auth (minimal)

- Email + password sign up / log in
- Basic profile: name, age, photo, city (manual entry, no GPS)
- Session persistence

2. Verification screen (UI only)

- Show the \$5 verification paywall screen in the flow
- "Verify" button skips straight through (no Stripe, no ID check yet)
- Purpose: demonstrates the monetization + trust model on camera

3. Live lobby / queue

- "Start Dating" button drops user into a waiting state
- Matching is **hardcoded/stubbed** — pair the two demo accounts every time
- Simple "Finding your date..." animation (3–5 sec fake delay is fine)

4. The 3-minute video date (the whole product)

- Two-way WebRTC video + audio between two browsers
- Visible countdown timer (3:00), prominent in UI
- Auto-end at 0:00 → transition to decision screen

- “Leave date” button (early exit → both users return to lobby)

5. Decision + match

- Post-date screen: **Match** or **Pass** buttons
- If both tap Match → “It’s a Swoon!” mutual match screen
- If either passes → return to lobby
- Basic text chat unlocked after mutual match (can be very simple — send/receive, no read receipts)

6. Brand pass

- Swoon logo, blush palette (#f4cccc / #ffc2c2, #2d2727 charcoal, #eeeeee cream, #4d779d accent)
 - Only on the screens that appear in the demo: lobby, date, decision, match
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P1 — Only if P0 is done early

- Deploy to tryswoon.com (replace placeholder)
- Report/block button on the date screen (can be non-functional UI for now)
- Mobile-responsive layout for the demo screens

Explicitly OUT of scope (do not build)

- Real matching algorithm or radius/location logic
- Stripe / payments
- ID verification integration
- Push notifications
- Game-show modes (Love Island, balloon pop, 20v1) — roadmap only
- Premium tier, swipe limits
- App store builds — web only for pre-alpha
- Analytics

- Settings, account deletion, password reset
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Engineering standards (applies even at pre-alpha)

- Human-legible code: clear naming, comments explaining the *why*
- README with setup steps + basic architecture notes
- API keys in environment variables, never committed
- Rate limiting + input validation on all endpoints
- Authorization check on every object access (users can only see their own data)

Definition of done

Two people on separate machines can: sign up → hit Start Dating → get connected on live video with a running timer → both tap Match → see the mutual match screen. Recorded in one unbroken take.